A PRACTICAL WORKSHOP — 10 MIN

UX with AI.
Claude & Figma, across the frameworks you already use.

UCD · Double Diamond · Design Thinking

CONTEXT

The frameworks aren't broken.
They're being squeezed.

↗ PRESSURE

Stakeholders want faster turnarounds. Scope expands. Deadlines don't.

↙ FRICTION

Research, synthesis, and first drafts still take the same time they did a decade ago.

AI doesn't replace the frameworks. It compresses specific activities inside them — synthesis, divergent ideation, first drafts.

Three frameworks at a glance.

01 — UCD

User-Centered Design

Iterative. Evidence-driven. Users inform every loop.

Understand
Specify
Design
Evaluate

02 — 2×◇

Double Diamond

Rhythmic. Alternates divergent and convergent thinking.

Discover (diverge)
Define (converge)
Develop (diverge)
Deliver (converge)

03 — DT

Design Thinking

Non-linear. Empathy-led. Prototype to learn.

Empathize
Define
Ideate
Prototype
Test

Different vocabularies — overlapping activities. We'll map AI onto each.

FRAMEWORK 01 — USER-CENTERED DESIGN

User-Centered Design with AI.

STAGE 01

Understand Context

Claude — cluster interview notes, surface themes, translate research.

STAGE 02

Specify Requirements

Claude — draft jobs-to-be-done, acceptance criteria, user stories.

STAGE 03

Design Solutions

Figma AI — First Draft, Make Designs, rename layers, fill copy.

STAGE 04

Evaluate

Claude — usability scripts, open-ended analysis, report drafts.

RULE → Humans keep ownership of user evidence and the final call.

FRAMEWORK 02 — DOUBLE DIAMOND

Double Diamond with AI.

DIVERGENT

Discover

Explore the problem space — broad, messy, many inputs.

AI → heavy. 50 problem framings, transcript synthesis, secondary research.

CONVERGENT

Define

Narrow to the right problem. Commit to one brief.

AI → light. Use Claude as a critic, not a decider.

DIVERGENT

Develop

Generate concepts — screens, flows, interaction patterns.

AI → heavy. Figma AI for screen drafts; Claude for interaction patterns.

CONVERGENT

Deliver

Refine, polish, ship. Specification and handoff.

AI → light. Spec docs, changelog copy, accessibility checks.

PATTERN → Lean on AI when diverging. Pull back when converging.

FRAMEWORK 03 — DESIGN THINKING

Design Thinking with AI.

01
Empathize
Claude — transcripts & synthesis. Don't flatten real conversations.

02
Define
Claude — POV statements, HMW framings, problem clustering.

03
Ideate
Claude + Figma AI — volume ideation, crazy 8s, wild cards.

04
Prototype
Figma AI — first-pass screens, component scaffolding, placeholder copy.

05
Test
Claude — script drafts, response analysis. Keep sessions human.

WARNING → Don't let AI flatten the empathy phase. Transcripts are fine; skipping real users is not.

TOOLS COMPARED

Claude and Figma AI — where each shines.

THE THINKING PARTNER

Claude

Language, synthesis, structure, critique, divergent ideation.

USE FOR Research synthesis

USE FOR Framing & rewrites

USE FOR Brainstorm volume

USE FOR Heuristic review

THE MAKING PARTNER

Figma AI

Turning intent into pixels — screens, layers, content, components.

USE FOR First Draft screens

USE FOR Make Designs prompts

USE FOR Rename & organize layers

USE FOR Placeholder content

Claude handles **what** and **why**. Figma AI handles **how it looks**.

HONEST ACCOUNTING

Benefits, and the costs they hide.

+ BENEFITS

30–50%

time saved on synthesis & first drafts

Broader ideation — 10× more framings per hour.

Less blank page — momentum from minute one.

Better collaboration — shared artifacts faster.

— TRADEOFFS

Drift to generic. AI outputs tend toward the average of the web.

Hallucinated evidence. Quotes, citations, and "users said" lines can be fabricated.

Lost intuition. Skipping synthesis means skipping the thinking.

Visual sameness. Figma AI defaults toward SaaS-template aesthetics.

HEURISTIC → Use AI to get to draft one faster — not to skip the thinking that draft one forces you to do.

★ THE KEY IDEA

Strategy is stitched to the project type.

PROJECT TYPE A

Greenfield / concept

Lean in heavy.

Claude for framing & territory mapping. Figma AI for rapid concept screens. Goal is optionality.

AI DENSITY

PROJECT TYPE B

Established redesign

Selective.

Claude for heuristic review & synthesis. Design work stays human — the system carries constraints AI won't know.

AI DENSITY

PROJECT TYPE C

Research-heavy

Evidence-first.

Claude for transcript work & reporting. Ideation stays grounded in findings — no AI speculation before data.

AI DENSITY

NO SINGLE WORKFLOW → Match the AI rhythm to the project in front of you.

STITCHING IN PRACTICE — 2-WEEK CONCEPT SPRINT

A practical stitching example.

DAY	ACTIVITY	WHO DRIVES
01	Claude synthesizes six interview transcripts into themes.	AI-led, human-reviewed
02	You cluster and validate themes by hand.	Human-only
03	Claude generates 20 problem framings. You pick three.	AI-led, human-decides
04–05	Figma AI drafts screens per framing. You refine.	Co-pilot mode
06→	Prototype, test, iterate — no AI in user sessions.	Human-only

PATTERN → AI is front-loaded. Human work is back-loaded.

WATCH FOR THESE

Five pitfalls to avoid.

01 Treating output as finished

Every AI response is draft one. Edit, cut, rewrite.

02 Skipping synthesis

Summary ≠ understanding. Read the transcripts yourself.

03 Vague prompts

Vague in, generic out. Bring constraints and examples.

04 AI in the research room

Live sessions stay human. AI breaks trust and rapport.

05 Letting Figma AI set your visual direction

Define the design language first. Then generate inside its constraints.

CLOSE

Three takeaways, one next step.

TAKEAWAY 01

Map AI to the divergent and synthesis stages of your framework.

TAKEAWAY 02

Claude and Figma AI solve different problems. Use them together.

TAKEAWAY 03

Tailor your strategy to the project type. No single workflow fits.

NEXT STEP — THIS WEEK

Pick one project. Map it to a framework. Identify two places to try AI.

Thanks →
Questions?